

Open Source firms selected for new trading desk solution

dbConcert has introduced a complete trading desk solution that gives the financial services industry a way to automate a majority of business functions done by most trading desks today. The solution, based entirely on open source products from Ingres, Marketcetera, and Pentaho, allows organisations to manage their business effectively and make better investment decisions—all at a fraction of the cost of proprietary software offerings.

"The days of the five million dollar projects are over," said Stephen Ferrando, chief executive officer, dbConcert. "No CIO has space in his budget to write that cheque. People are looking to open source to continue to innovate, to continue with new projects, without writing a bigger cheque. No one wants to spend if they don't know it will work. Open source gives you the ability to try it out without locking yourself in to millions of dollars of payments in the coming years."

Marketcetera, an open source trading system provider, recently launched the first open source trading platform. dbConcert took the Marketcetera solution and combined business intelligence (BI) from Pentaho, and the database from Ingres to create a complete open source solution framework built on Eclipse. The offering enables end users to execute orders electronically, track order flow, analyse market positions, and measure profit and loss.

Intel notifies AMD of cross-licence breach

Intel claims to have notified Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) that it believes AMD has breached a 2001 patent cross-licence agreement with Intel. Intel believes that Global Foundries is not a subsidiary under terms of the agreement and is therefore not licensed under the 2001 patent cross-licence agreement. Intel also said the structure of the deal between AMD and ATIC breaches a confidential portion of that agreement. Intel has asked AMD to make the relevant portion of the agreement public, but so far AMD has declined to do so, state sources in Intel. AMD's breach could result in the loss of licences and rights granted to AMD by Intel under the agreement.

"Intellectual property is a cornerstone of Intel's technology leadership and for more than 30 years, the company has believed in the strategic importance of licensing intellectual property in exchange for fair value. However, AMD cannot unilaterally extend Intel's licensing rights to a third party without Intel's consent," said Bruce Sewell, senior vice president and general counsel for Intel. "We have attempted to address our concerns with AMD without success since October. We are willing to find a resolution but at the same time we have an obligation to our stockholders to protect the billions of dollars we've invested in intellectual property," he added.

Under terms of the licence agreement, the notification to AMD means the parties will attempt to resolve the dispute through mediation. In response to the notification, AMD claimed Intel breached the agreement by notifying AMD of its breach. Intel believes that this position is inconsistent with the dispute resolution process outlined in the original agreement.

For the want of an OSS in-vehicle infotainment platform

Leading automobile manufacturers and suppliers announced the formation of the GENIVI Alliance, a non-profit organisation committed to driving the development and broad adoption of an open source In-Vehicle Infotainment (IVI) reference platform. The new alliance will unite industry-leading automotive, consumer electronics, communications and application development companies investing in the IVI market. The effort will result both in reducing time-to-market and total cost of ownership.

GENIVI Alliance founding members—the BMW Group, Delphi, General Motors Corp., Intel, Magneti Marelli, PSA Peugeot Citroën, Visteon Corp., and Wind River—are collaborating to create a shared GENIVI platform, a common software architecture that is scalable across product lines and generations. The GENIVI platform will accelerate the pace at which auto-makers can deliver new solutions, bringing them closer to the lifecycle of consumer devices, and accelerating new business models, such as connected services.

"GENIVI will challenge the traditional approach of proprietary solutions and spawn a level of creativity not yet seen in this segment," said Graham Smethurst, GENIVI spokesperson and BMW group general manager, Infotainment and Communication Systems. "Collaborating on a common reference platform in non-differentiating areas of the architecture will allow GENIVI members to focus on the development and integration of innovative functionality."

